

can harness this realignment of technology and communication. Weblogs will give rise to a new “generation” of authorities by making it easy to share meaningful information and content as needed, and at the fast-paced and often irregular speed of business.

Weblogs: Realigning Business Technology & Communication

From the Consumer to the Business World

The earliest weblogs were simple lists of URLs of new sites as they arrived on the web. Their evolution began with The National Center for Supercomputing Applications (NCSA), which introduced a “What’s New” weblog page. Shortly after, Netscape launched its own “What’s New” page, one of the most viewed blogs of the mid 90’s. The end of the decade brought the Internet explosion, an event that expanded and transformed our lines of communication, and it took weblogs along for the ride. Structured like personal online diaries, consumer weblogs were the next stage of the evolution, giving individuals a way to share their most intimate thoughts and feelings. The writing was witty, irreverent, and often bombastic. Soon there was a whole Internet subculture of ‘blogger communities’ - crowding around each other’s most intimate thoughts and feelings like groupies around a table in a digital cafe. Slowly but surely, the most successful weblogs grew from one person’s need to share with a friend to one person’s ability to rivet the attention of hundreds.

Today, there are thousands upon thousands of weblogs. There are weblogs devoted to nothing but cataloguing weblogs. Moreover, they’re already evolving into a business tool that is beginning to gain strength in complementing current content-based technology. In the past, Internet publishing has lacked infrastructure and while there have been many information-rich sites, few have had a distinctive opinion or “voice.” Weblogs provide a point of view and will generate power in the audiences that they inspire. The “voice” of a weblog will be the main point of interest and will create a following. The best weblogs will be those that create interest through relevant or insightful content and will gain